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between the total of the debit column and credit column of all the ledger accounts is called balancing.

(iii) Preparation of trial balance

The list of ledger balances namely trial balance is prepared as the next step. On the basis of ledger balances the financial statements are prepared.

(iv) Preparation of trading account

Next step is preparation of trading account for a particular accounting period. All the direct revenues and direct expenses are transferred to trading account. The balance in the trading account is the gross profit or gross loss.

(v) Preparation of profit and loss account

Profit and loss account is prepared next for a particular accounting period. All the indirect revenues and indirect expenses along with gross profit or gross loss are transferred to profit and loss account. The balance in the profit and loss account is the net profit or net loss.

(vi) Preparation of balance sheet

A statement showing the balances of assets and liabilities namely balance sheet is prepared as the final step in the accounting process. It is prepared on a particular date, normally, on the last day of the accounting period.

The closing balances of an accounting year are taken as the opening balances for the next accounting year. The transactions identified and recorded for the next year are followed by posting and other steps.

The results are communicated to the users of accounting information for the purpose of analysis and decision making.

1.5 Objectives of Accounting

Following are the objectives of accounting:

i) To keep a systematic record of financial transactions and events

ii) To ascertain the profit or loss of the business enterprise

iii) To ascertain the financial position or status of the enterprise

iv) To provide information to various stakeholders for their requirements

v) To protect the properties of an enterprise and

vi) To ascertain the solvency and liquidity position of an enterprise